

FILM DOSSIER: WOLVERINE

Phase 3 · Film #5 (Saga Film #22)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	22 of 29 (Phase 3, Film #5)
Phase	Phase 3
Real title	WOLVERINE
Decoy / codename title	"CHERRY BLOSSOM"
Release date	Friday, July 28, 2017
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	James Mangold
Rating / runtime	PG-13 (<i>the hard end of it</i>) · 148 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + samurai drama / crime noir

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	HUGH JACKMAN , the only real actor to have played Logan. The Wolverine franchise is his.

Character	Actor	Age at release
Logan / Wolverine	Hugh Jackman	48
Mariko Yashida	Tao Okamoto	32
Lord Shingen Yashida	Hiroyuki Sanada	56
Yukio	Rila Fukushima	29
Bruce Banner / The Hulk (<i>prologue</i>)	Amond Baker	35
Professor Charles Xavier (<i>post-credit</i>)	Patrick Stewart	77
Mistress Death (<i>uncredited</i>)	Aubrey Plaza	33
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a Tokyo businessman who recognizes Logan's type: "Canadian!"</i>)	Stan Lee	94

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>Wolverine</i> #1–4 (1982), Chris Claremont & Frank Miller: Logan goes to Japan for Mariko Yashida , and faces her father Lord Shingen, the Hand and Yukio . <i>"I'm the best there is at what I do. But what I do best isn't very nice."</i>
Supporting comics	<i>The Incredible Hulk</i> #180–181 (1974): Wolverine's first appearance , a Canadian agent sent to stop the Hulk and the Wendigo (the prologue) · <i>Giant-Size X-Men</i> #1 (1975): Xavier recruits Logan (the post-credit scene) · <i>Weapon X</i> , <i>Marvel Comics Presents</i> #72–84 (1991): the adamantium (flashbacks) · <i>Origin</i> (2001): James Howlett , born in 1880s Canada (flashbacks)
Nerf check	✅ Shingen beats Logan with a wooden practice sword in their first duel, because Logan was drugged , exactly as in <i>Wolverine</i> #2. In the rematch at full strength, Logan wins .

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	97% . The Claremont/Miller series is adapted issue for issue, with Logan's debut as the prologue.

Straight from the page:

- **Prologue**: in the Canadian wilderness, a government agent codenamed **Weapon X / Wolverine** is sent to stop **the Hulk** and **the Wendigo** (*Hulk* #180–181).

- **Mariko Yashida**, the woman Logan loves, has been **forced into an arranged marriage** by her father, the crime lord **Lord Shingen Yashida** (*Wolverine* #1).
- **Logan is drugged, then beaten by Shingen with a wooden bokken** in a duel, and **thrown out** (#1–2).
- **Yukio**, a reckless assassin, is sent to kill him and **falls for him** (#2–3).
- **The Hand**, a clan of ninja assassins, works for Shingen (#3).
- **Logan comes back at full strength, kills the Hand's ninjas, and kills Shingen in a real duel** (#4).
- **Mariko**, freed, **accepts Logan's proposal** (#4).
- **Flashbacks: James Howlett**, 1880s Canada (*Origin*); **the Weapon X program** bonding adamantium to his skeleton (*Weapon X*).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| His 1974 debut becomes the prologue | It gives Logan an **MCU entrance** against a character audiences already know |

| Shingen's death is **shown carefully** for PG-13 | The rating. The duel is intact. |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Wolverine	Regenerative healing factor (heals from nearly anything; slowed aging, born in the 1880s); an unbreakable adamantium skeleton and retractable adamantium claws ; animal-keen senses ; berserker rage ; master martial artist (samurai-trained), fluent in Japanese (<i>Hulk</i> #180 on)	All of it: heals from a point-blank shotgun blast, cuts a car in half, tracks by scent through Tokyo, the berserker rage against the Hand	–	✓ 100%
The Hulk (<i>prologue</i>)	Limitless strength	Throws Logan through a forest as Logan keeps getting back up, and it ends in a draw (616)	–	✓ 100%
Shingen	A master swordsman , one of the best in Japan; crime lord	Beats a drugged Logan with a bokken; the final duel	–	✓ 100%
Yukio	Expert assassin and acrobat	Knife-throwing and rooftop runs	–	✓ 100%
The Hand	Ninja assassins; mystic resurrection (616)	Dozens of them	Their full mystic power (a later film)	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	The best there is at what he does goes to Japan for the woman he loves, and loses to her father with a stick. He has to become more than an animal to win her back.
Theme	The animal and the samurai. Logan is at war with himself. Honor is the only thing that can make him a man.
Villain / antagonist	Lord Shingen Yashida (main); the Hand

What the movie is about

PROLOGUE: THE WENDIGO

- **The Canadian Rockies, Monday, April 24, 2017.** A government agent in a yellow-and-blue suit, **Wolverine**,

parachutes in to stop the **Wendigo**, and finds **the Hulk** fighting it too.

- Three-way fight. The Hulk throws Logan through a forest **six times**. Logan keeps getting up.
- **HULK**: "*Why won't little man stay down?!*"
- It ends in a draw. Logan lights a cigar.

ACT ONE: JAPAN

- Logan's letters to **Mariko Yashida** have been coming back unopened. He goes to **Tokyo**.
- Her father, **Lord Shingen**, a crime lord, has **forced her to marry** one of his allies.
- Shingen **drugs Logan** and duels him with **a wooden sword**. **Logan loses** in front of Mariko.
- He's thrown out, humiliated.

ACT TWO: YUKIO

- A wild, reckless assassin named **Yukio** is sent to kill him. They end up drinking together.
- Flashbacks: **James Howlett**, a sick boy in 1880s Canada; **the Weapon X program**, the adamantium, the screaming.
- The **Hand**, Shingen's ninja army, comes for him. The berserker rage takes over, and afterward Logan looks at the bodies, ashamed.
- Yukio: "*You're an animal.*" Logan: "*I'm trying not to be.*"

ACT THREE: HONOR

- Logan **goes back**, clear-headed, at full strength, and in control.
- **Logan vs. Shingen**: a real duel with real swords in the Yashida garden. **Logan wins**.
- **Mariko is free**. She accepts his proposal.
- The last line, over a sunset in Kyoto: "*I'm the best there is at what I do. But what I do best isn't very nice.*"

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	1880s Canada (flashbacks) · Monday, April 24, 2017 (the prologue) → Saturday, June 24, 2017 (Kyoto). The post-credit scene is the following week .
Where it's set	The Canadian Rockies · Tokyo · the Yashida estate · Kyoto (filmed on location in Japan and Alberta)
Relative to other films	Three weeks after the London battle (<i>Cosmic Avengers</i>). Logan reads about "space Avengers" in a Tokyo paper and grunts.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Logan's past:** Howlett, Weapon X, Department H.
- **Japan:** Mariko, Yukio, the Hand.
- **The code:** the samurai and the animal.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Wolverine vs. the Hulk	The prologue	Future films
The X-Men	The post-credit scene: Giant-Size X-Men	The X-Men sequel (Phase 3)
The Hand	Their resurrection magic	Street-level stories (Phase 3 and later)

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Death can't keep him	In the Hand's massacre, Logan is stabbed through the heart. The hooded woman kneels beside him, and his heart starts beating again under her hand . She looks almost amused, and leaves.	Even Death can't hold Logan . On 616, Wolverine is one of the heroes who faces Thanos in <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> #4.

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✅ "GROCERIES." Logan tries to buy beer at a Tokyo convenience store. The clerk asks for ID. Logan (who was born in the 1880s): <i>"...Really?"</i>
Post-credit scene	✅ "GIANT-SIZE." A Canadian roadhouse. Professor Charles Xavier rolls up to Logan's table. XAVIER: <i>"Mr. Logan. My X-Men have been taken. I need a new team, and I'm told you're the best there is."</i> LOGAN: <i>"At what?"</i> XAVIER (smiling): <i>"At what you do."</i> Logan grins. CUT TO BLACK. "WOLVERINE WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "CONVENIENCE STORE." Post-credit: "JOB INTERVIEW."

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Comic(s) adapted · ☐ Comic Accuracy Report + powers · ☐ Real and decoy titles · ☐ What it's about · ☐ Villain · ☐ Post-credit scenes · ☐ The film's own world-building · ☐ MCU world-building · ☐ Big Bad setup · ☐ Whose franchise · ☐ When and where in the timeline